

Climbing is the greatest of the sports, and climbing well is the best part of climbing. We suffer through an endless quest for performance, and we too often get sucked down the path of more: more volume, more complexity, more exercises. I urge you to consider that this is not always the way.

Your training structure can, and should, be simple. Whether you follow the exact prescriptions in this book or you elect to follow just the idea of a nonlinear or block structure, I hope you find your way to higher grades and more consistent performance. As with everything I write, I consider this an exploration into an idea. I see it as a question to be asked, not a statement to be defended.

As this is the second edition of this book, you understand that there were certain things in the first that were not quite right or needed more exploration. I have no doubt that this is true of all books, and at some point, a third book might follow. I get accused of confusing readers sometimes because I “change my mind” on certain things. I do change my mind, and I am glad I can do it. Changing your mind is learning.

A full-page photograph of a rock climber on a massive, textured brown rock face. The climber is positioned in the lower-middle section of the frame, wearing a dark long-sleeved shirt, dark pants, and a helmet. They are reaching up with their right arm towards a rock feature. A rope is visible running vertically down the rock face. The rock surface is highly textured with various cracks and ledges. The word "ACKNOWLEDGEMENTS" is overlaid in white, bold, sans-serif capital letters in the upper-middle part of the image.

ACKNOWLEDGEMENTS

PHOTO: MATT PINCUS

As always, these books are not about one person writing his ideas. In the case of this book, it is the result of many athletes testing and modifying the original plans, as well as many, many others who helped with the second edition's edits and changes. I am grateful, especially, to our team at Climb Strong who coach, plan, edit, revise, put out fires, and inspire growth. To Alex, Amanda, Ellen, Charlie, Josh, Carly, Ken, Chrissy, and Kathryn - thank you! Big thanks to all of my athletes for making this a rewarding and fun career. I am also grateful to our Performance Climbing Coach team: Neely, Kris, Jared, Kelly, Christina, Tyler, and Mercedes. It is a gift to learn so much from you all, and to keep learning more.

Most of all, I'd like to thank Ellen, who has watched the compass heading for the last 16 years. Without you, there would be no gym, no books, and no coaching.

ABOUT STEVE BECHTEL

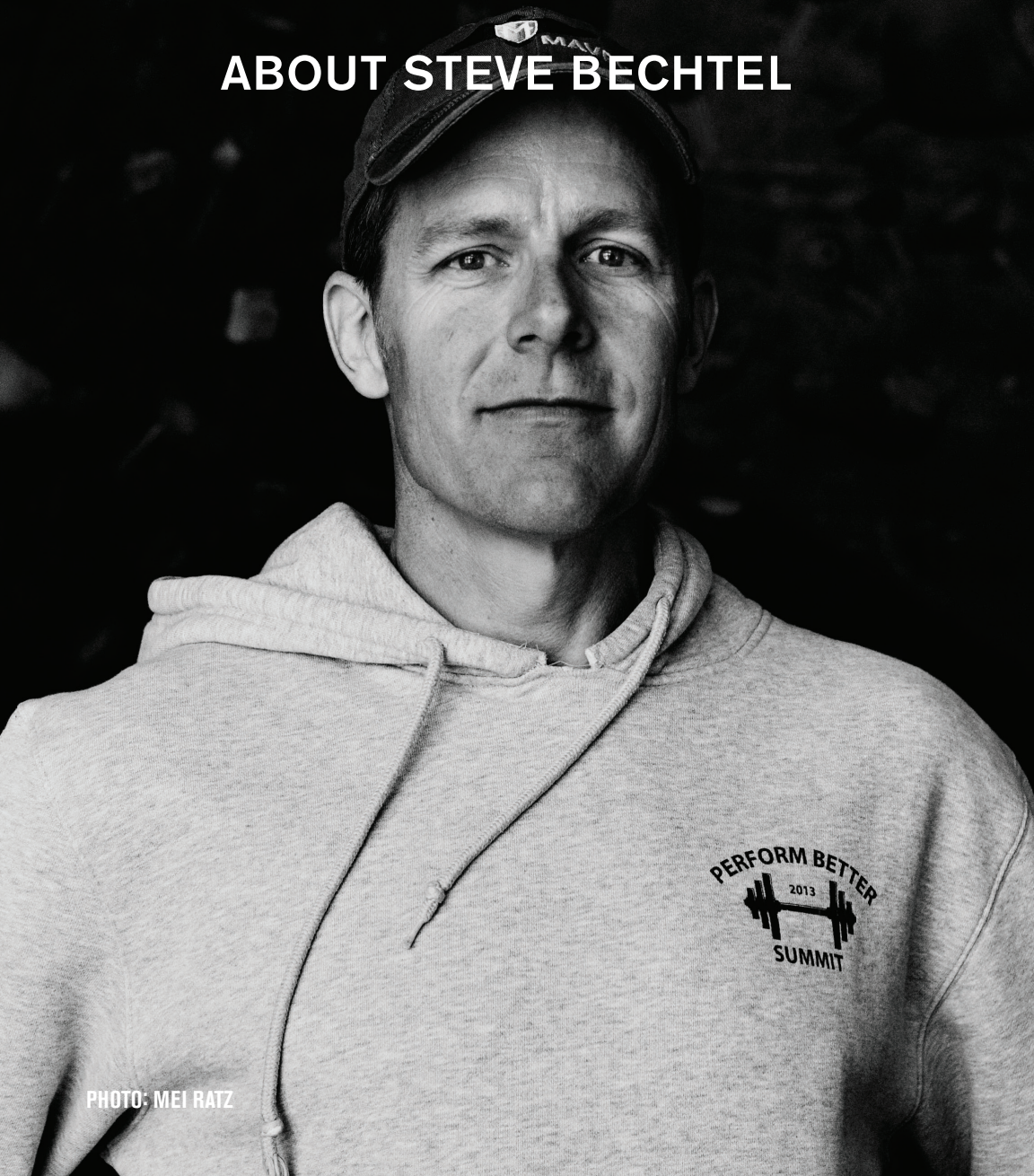


PHOTO: MEI RATZ

The founder of Elemental Performance + Fitness, Steve has been coaching strength and fitness for nearly thirty years. He is a Certified Strength and Conditioning Specialist (CSCS) and holds a degree in Exercise Physiology from the University of Wyoming. Steve is an SFG II, Certified Program Design Specialist, a PN1 Certified Nutrition Coach, A Certified Conditioning Coach, USA Weightlifting Certified Coach, a USA Cycling Elite-level coach, and has been coaching triathlon for over 25 years as a USAT-certified coach. A world-renowned expert in the training of rock climbers, he coaches many of the world's top-level climbers and writes extensively on climbing training on the website Climb Strong. Steve is also founder and educational manager for the Performance Climbing Coach seminars, events held several times each year to bring the best education possible to climbing coaches and serious athletes.

Steve is also a well-known adventure rock climber, having established new climbs on six continents. All told, he has done more than 400 first ascents across his 30+ year climbing career. His main focus these days is spending as much time as possible with his wife Ellen, and their children, Anabel and Sam.

